



Getting it together

Hold virtual meetings across cubicles and verify, edit and pass documents to others without taking your eyes off the monitor!

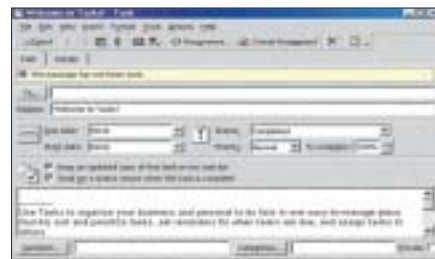
In a world where you need to keep running just to stay in position, and where everything is governed by one catchword—'faster', technology has given us some nifty tools that make it easier to communicate with others and manage work across the office more efficiently and with precision. Here are some tried and tested tricks of the trade that any office of the New Millennium cannot afford to miss.

Coordinate with Outlook

 Outlook offers some neat collaboration features—apart from e-mail, of course—that will help you share information and work together with your colleagues more efficiently.

You can use the Task and Calendar features in Outlook to coordinate work with others in the organisation. To set a task for a particular day, go to Task and double-click on 'Click here to add new task'. In the window that opens up, you can set the job, its due date and priority, and also gauge its progress. You can even set a reminder. To forward the task-sheet to others, all you have to do is press [Ctrl] + [F] and address it to the individuals concerned or groups.

If you need to delegate a job, set the task as described above and then send it to the person concerned by clicking 'Assign task'. You can keep track of the progress by opting to keep a copy with you by clicking 'Keep an updated copy of this task on my task list' and by choosing 'Send me a status report when this task is complete'.



Assign tasks through Outlook

The Notes facility helps you jot down things in the manner of a sticky note and they can be coloured individually to denote different subjects. You can categorise these notes by the subject such as holiday, business and even forward them to others.

Spread the word with Microsoft Word

 Microsoft Word too has some inbuilt capabilities to aid collaboration. When different people work on a document, you often end up with as many versions as the number of people involved. However, Word offers several features that help reduce the clutter and confusion.

Track changes: One of the easiest ways to keep track of the changes made to a document is through change tracking. Share the document so others can have access to it, or route it through e-mail (see box, 'Routing a Document for Review'). If you've shared the document, click on **Tools > Track Changes > Highlight changes** and